

can, could and (be) able to

A

We use **can** to say that something is possible or allowed, or that somebody has the ability to do something. We use **can** + *infinitive* (**can do** / **can see** etc.):

- ☐ We **can see** the lake from our hotel.
- ☐ 'I don't have a pen.' 'You **can use** mine.'
- ☐ **Can** you **speak** any foreign languages?
- ☐ I **can come** and see you tomorrow if you like.
- ☐ The word 'dream' **can be** a noun or a verb.

The negative is **can't** (= **cannot**):

- ☐ I'm afraid I **can't come** to the party on Friday.

B

You can say that somebody **is able to** do something, but **can** is more usual:

- ☐ We **are able to see** the lake from our hotel.

But **can** has only two forms: **can** (*present*) and **could** (*past*). So sometimes it is necessary to use **(be) able to**. Compare:

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ I can't sleep. | ☐ I haven't been able to sleep recently. |
| ☐ Tom can come tomorrow. | ☐ Tom might be able to come tomorrow. |
| ☐ Maria can speak French, Spanish and English. | ☐ Applicants for the job must be able to speak two foreign languages. |

C

Sometimes **could** is the past of **can**. We use **could** especially with:

see hear smell taste feel remember understand

- ☐ We had a lovely room in the hotel. We **could see** the lake.
- ☐ As soon as I walked into the room, I **could smell** gas.
- ☐ I was sitting at the back of the theatre and **couldn't hear** very well.

We also use **could** to say that somebody had the ability to do something, or was allowed to do something:

- ☐ My grandfather **could speak** five languages.
- ☐ We were totally free. We **could do** what we wanted. (= we were allowed to do)

D

could and **was able to**

We use **could** for *general* ability and with **see, hear** etc. :

- ☐ My grandfather **could speak** five languages.
- ☐ I **could see** them, but not very clearly.

But to say that somebody succeeded in doing something in a specific situation, we normally use **was/were able to** or **managed to** (*not could*):

- ☐ The fire spread quickly, but everybody **was able to escape**. (*not could escape*)
- ☐ I didn't know where Max was, but I **managed to find** him in the end. (*not could find*)

Compare:

- ☐ Jack was an excellent tennis player when he was younger. He **could beat** anybody.
(= he was good enough to beat anybody, he had the ability)

but Jack and Andy played a match yesterday. Andy played well, but Jack **managed to beat** him.
(= he succeeded in beating him this time)

The negative **couldn't** (**could not**) is possible in all situations:

- ☐ My grandfather **couldn't swim**.
- ☐ I looked for Max everywhere, but I **couldn't find** him.
- ☐ Andy played well, but he **couldn't beat** Jack.

Exercises

26.1 Complete the sentences using *can* or *(be) able to*. If *can* is not possible, use *(be) able to*.

- 1 Gary has travelled a lot. He *can* speak five languages.
- 2 I haven't *been able to* sleep very well recently.
- 3 Nicole drive, but she doesn't have a car.
- 4 I used to stand on my head, but I can't do it any more.
- 5 I can't understand Mark. I've never understand him.
- 6 I can't see you on Friday, but I meet you on Saturday morning.
- 7 Ask Katherine about your problem. She might help you.
- 8 You have to be careful in this part of the city. It be dangerous.
- 9 Michael has lived in Italy a long time, so he should speak Italian.

26.2 Write sentences about yourself using the ideas in brackets.

- 1 (something you used to be able to do)
I used to be able to sing well.
- 2 (something you used to be able to do)
I used
- 3 (something you would like to be able to do)
I'd
- 4 (something you have never been able to do)
I've

26.3 Complete the sentences with *can/can't/could/couldn't* + the following:

believe come hear run sleep wait

- 1 I'm afraid I *can't come* to your party next week.
- 2 When Dan was 16, he 100 metres in 11 seconds.
- 3 'Are you in a hurry?' 'No, I've got plenty of time. I'
- 4 I don't feel good this morning. I last night.
- 5 Can you speak a little louder? I you very well.
- 6 I was amazed when I heard the news. I it.

26.4 Complete the answers to the questions with *was/were able to*

- 1 A: Did everybody escape from the fire?
B: Yes. The fire spread quickly, but everybody *was able to escape*.
- 2 A: Did you finish your work this afternoon?
B: Yes, there was nobody to disturb me, so I
- 3 A: Did you solve the problem?
B: Yes, we did. It wasn't easy, but we
- 4 A: Did the thief get away?
B: Yes. No-one realised what was happening and the thief

26.5 Complete the sentences using *could*, *couldn't* or *managed to*.

- 1 My grandfather travelled a lot. He *could* speak five languages.
- 2 I looked everywhere for the book, but I *couldn't* find it.
- 3 They didn't want to come with us at first, but we *managed to* persuade them.
- 4 Jessica had hurt her foot and walk very well.
- 5 There was a small fire in the kitchen, but fortunately I put it out.
- 6 The walls were thin and I hear people talking in the next room.
- 7 I ran my first marathon recently. It was very hard, but I finish.
- 8 My grandmother loved music. She play the piano very well.
- 9 We wanted to go to the concert, but we get tickets.
- 10 A girl fell into the river, but some people pull her out. She's all right now.

could (do) and could have (done)

A

Sometimes **could** is the past of **can** (see Unit 26):

- ☐ Listen. I **can hear** something. (*now*)
- ☐ I listened. I **could hear** something. (*past*)

But **could** is not always past. We also use **could** for possible actions now or in the future, especially to make suggestions. For example:

- ☐ A: What shall we do tonight?
B: We **could go** to the cinema.
- ☐ A: When you go to Paris next month,
you **could stay** with Sarah.
B: Yes, I suppose I **could**.

Can is also possible in these sentences ('We can go to the cinema' etc.). **Could** is less sure than **can**.

What shall we
do tonight?

We **could go** to the cinema.



B

We also use **could** (*not can*) for actions that are not realistic. For example:

- ☐ I'm so tired, I **could sleep** for a week. (*not I can sleep for a week*)

Compare **can** and **could**:

- ☐ I **can stay** with Sarah when I go to Paris. (*realistic*)
- ☐ Maybe I **could stay** with Sarah when I go to Paris. (*possible, but less sure*)
- ☐ This is a wonderful place. I **could stay** here for ever. (*unrealistic*)

C

We also use **could** (*not can*) to say that something is possible now or in the future:

- ☐ The story **could be** true, but I don't think it is. (*not can be true*)
- ☐ I don't know what time Lisa is coming. She **could get** here at any time.

Compare **can** and **could**:

- ☐ The weather **can** change very quickly in the mountains. (*in general*)
- ☐ The weather is nice now, but it **could** change later. (*the weather now, not in general*)

D

We use **could have** (done) to talk about the past. Compare:

- ☐ I'm so tired, I **could sleep** for a week. (*now*)
I was so tired, I **could have slept** for a week. (*past*)
- ☐ The situation is bad, but it **could be** worse. (*now*)
The situation was bad, but it **could have been** worse. (*past*)

Something **could have** happened = it was possible, but did *not* happen:

- ☐ Why did you stay at a hotel? You **could have stayed** with me.
- ☐ David was lucky. He **could have hurt** himself when he fell, but he's all right.

E

I **couldn't do** something = it would not be possible:

- ☐ I **couldn't live** in a big city. I'd hate it. (= it wouldn't be possible for me)
- ☐ Everything is fine right now. Things **couldn't be** better.

For the past we use **couldn't have** ... (= would not have been possible):

- ☐ We had a really good holiday. It **couldn't have been** better.

Note that 'I **couldn't do** something' has two meanings:

- (1) I **couldn't** = it would not be possible now, I would not be able:
 - ☐ I **couldn't run** ten kilometres now. I'm not fit enough. (= I would not be able)
- (2) I **couldn't** = I was not able (past)
 - ☐ I **couldn't run** yesterday because I'd hurt my leg. (= I was not able)

Exercises

27.1 Which goes with which?

- 1 What shall we eat tonight?
- 2 I need to phone Vicky sometime.
- 3 What shall I get Ann for her birthday?
- 4 Where shall we put this picture?
- 5 What would you like to do at the weekend?
- 6 I don't know what to wear to the wedding.

- a We could go away somewhere.
- b You could give her a book.
- c ~~We could have fish.~~
- d You could wear your brown suit.
- e You could do it now.
- f We could hang it in the kitchen.

- 1 c
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- 6

27.2 Put in **can** or **could**.

- 1 This is a wonderful place. I could stay here forever.
- 2 I'm so angry with him. I kill him!
- 3 I hear a strange noise. What is it?
- 4 It's so nice here. I sit here all day but unfortunately I have to go.
- 5 I understand your point of view, but I don't agree with you.
- 6 Peter is a keen musician. He plays the flute and he also play the piano.
- 7 The company Amy works for isn't doing well. She lose her job.
- 8 Some people are unlucky. Life be very unfair.
- 9 I've been really stupid. I kick myself.
- 10 Be careful climbing that tree. You fall.

27.3 Complete the sentences. Choose from:

gone
have moved

could be
could have

could come
could have come

~~**could sleep**~~
~~**could have been**~~

- 1 A: Are you tired?
B: Yes, very tired. I feel as if I could sleep for a week.
- 2 A: I spent a very boring evening at home yesterday.
B: Why did you stay at home? You out with us.
- 3 A: Shall I open this letter?
B: Yes. It important.
- 4 A: How was your exam? Was it difficult?
B: It wasn't so bad. It worse.
- 5 A: I got very wet walking home in the rain.
B: Why did you walk? You taken a taxi.
- 6 A: Where shall we meet tomorrow?
B: Well, I to your office if you like.
- 7 A: Does Tom still live in the same place?
B: I'm not sure. He could
- 8 A: Did you go to university?
B: No. I could have, but I didn't want to.

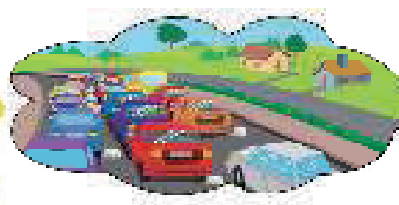
27.4 Complete the sentences. Use **couldn't** or **couldn't have** + these verbs (in the correct form):

afford **be** ~~**be**~~ ~~**live**~~ **manage** **stand** **study** **wear**

- 1 I couldn't live in a big city. I'd hate it.
- 2 We had a really good holiday. It couldn't have been better.
- 3 I that hat. People would laugh at me.
- 4 You helped me a lot. I without you.
- 5 The staff at the hotel were really good. They more helpful.
- 6 There's no way we could buy a car now. We it.
- 7 Jack prepared for the exam as well as he could. He harder.
- 8 I wouldn't like to live near the motorway. I the noise of the traffic.

A Study this example:

My house is very near the motorway.

It **must be** very noisy.We use **must** to say that we believe something is certain:

- ☐ You've been travelling all day. You **must be** tired.
(travelling is tiring and you've been travelling all day, so you **must** be tired)
- ☐ 'Joe is a hard worker.' 'Joe? You **must be joking**. He doesn't do anything.'
- ☐ Louise **must get** very bored in her job. She does the same thing every day.

We use **can't** to say that we believe something is not possible:

- ☐ You've just had lunch. You **can't be** hungry already.
(we don't expect people to be hungry immediately after a meal)
- ☐ They haven't lived here for very long. They **can't know** many people.

The structure is:

you/she/they (etc.)	must can't	be (tired / hungry / at work etc.) be -ing (doing / going / joking etc.) get / know / have etc.
---------------------	-----------------------	--

B Study this example:

There's nobody at home. They **must have gone** out.

Martin and Lucy expected their friends to be at home.

They rang the doorbell twice, but nobody has answered. Lucy says:

They **must have gone** out.
(= there is no other possibility)For the past we use **must have ...** and **can't have ...**:

- ☐ I lost one of my gloves. I **must have dropped** it somewhere.
(that's the only explanation I can think of)
- ☐ 'We used to live very near the motorway.' 'Did you? It **must have been** noisy.'
- ☐ Sarah hasn't contacted me. She **can't have got** my message.
- ☐ Max walked into a wall. He **can't have been looking** where he was going.

The structure is:

I/you/he (etc.)	must can't	have	been (asleep / at work etc.) been -ing (doing / looking etc.) gone / got / known etc.
-----------------	-----------------------	-------------	--

You can use **couldn't have** instead of **can't have**:

- ☐ Sarah **couldn't have got** my message.
- ☐ Max **couldn't have been looking** where he was going.

Exercises

28.1 Put in **must** or **can't**.

- 1 You've been travelling all day. You must be tired.
- 2 That restaurant be very good. It's always full of people.
- 3 That restaurant be very good. It's always empty.
- 4 I'm sure Kate gave me her address. I have it somewhere.
- 5 I often see that man in this street. He live near here.
- 6 It rained every day during their holiday. It have been very nice for them.
- 7 Congratulations on passing your exam. You be very pleased.
- 8 This bill be correct. It's much too high.
- 9 You got here very quickly. You have driven very fast.
- 10 Bill and Sue always stay at five-star hotels. They be short of money.
- 11 Karen hasn't left the office yet. She be working late tonight.

28.2 Complete each sentence with a verb (one or two words).

- 1 I've lost one of my gloves. I must have dropped it somewhere.
- 2 Their house is very near the motorway. It must be very noisy.
- 3 You've lived in this village a long time. You must everybody who lives here.
- 4 I don't seem to have my wallet with me. I must it at home.
- 5 'How old is Ed?' 'He's older than me. He must at least 40.'
- 6 I didn't hear my phone. I must asleep.
- 7 'You're going on holiday soon. You must forward to it.' 'Yes, I am.'
- 8 I'm sure you know this song. You must it before.
- 9 The road is closed, so we have to go another way. There must an accident.
- 10 'Do you have a car?' 'You must! How could I afford to have a car?'
- 11 David is the managing director of a large company, so he must quite a high salary.

28.3 Use the words in brackets to write sentences with **must have** and **can't have**.

- 1 We went to our friends' house and rang the doorbell, but nobody answered. (they / go out)
They must have gone out.
- 2 Sarah hasn't contacted me. (she / get / my message)
She can't have got my message.
- 3 The jacket you bought is very good quality. (it / be / very expensive)
.....
- 4 I haven't seen our neighbours for the last few days. (they / go away)
.....
- 5 I can't find my umbrella. (I / leave / it in the restaurant last night)
.....
- 6 Amy was in a very difficult situation when she lost her job. (it / be / easy for her)
.....
- 7 There was a man standing outside the cafe. He was there a long time. (he / wait / for somebody)
.....
- 8 Rachel did the opposite of what I asked her to do. (she / understand / what I said)
.....
- 9 When I got back to my car, it was unlocked. (I / forget / to lock it)
.....
- 10 My neighbours were making a lot of noise in the night. It woke me up. (they / have / a party)
.....
- 11 The light was red, but the car didn't stop. (the driver / see / the red light)
.....
- 12 Paul has had these shoes for years, but they still look new. (he / wear / them much)
.....

may and might 1

A

Study this example situation:

You are looking for Ben. Nobody is sure where he is, but you get some suggestions.



Where's Ben?

He **may** be in his office. (= perhaps he is in his office)

He **might** be having lunch. (= perhaps he is having lunch)

Ask Kate. She **might** know. (= perhaps she knows)

We use **may** or **might** to say that something is possible. You can use **may** or **might**:

- ☐ It **may** be true. or It **might** be true. (= perhaps it is true)
- ☐ She **might** know. or She **may** know.

The negative forms are **may not** and **might not**:

- ☐ It **may not** be true. (= perhaps it isn't true)
- ☐ She **might not** know. (= perhaps she doesn't know)

I/you/he (etc.)	may might	(not)	be (true / in his office etc.) be -ing (doing / working / having etc.) know / work / want etc.
-----------------	----------------------------	-------	---

Note the difference between **may be** (2 words) and **maybe** (1 word):

- ☐ It **may be** true. (**may** + verb)
- ☐ 'Is it true?' '**Maybe**. I'm not sure.' (**maybe** = it's possible, perhaps)

B

For the past we use **may have ...** or **might have ...**:

- ☐ A: I wonder why Kate didn't answer her phone.
B: She **may have been** asleep. (= perhaps she was asleep)
- ☐ A: I can't find my phone anywhere.
B: You **might have left** it at work. (= perhaps you left it at work)
- ☐ A: Why wasn't Amy at the meeting yesterday?
B: She **might not have known** about it. (= perhaps she didn't know)
- ☐ A: I wonder why David was in such a bad mood yesterday.
B: He **may not have been feeling** well. (= perhaps he wasn't feeling well)

I/you/he (etc.)	may might	(not) have	been (asleep / at home etc.) been -ing (doing / working / feeling etc.) known / had / wanted / left etc.
-----------------	----------------------------	------------	---

C

could is similar to **may** and **might**:

- ☐ It's a strange story, but it **could be** true. (= it is possible that it's true)
- ☐ You **could have left** your phone at work. (= it's possible that you left it there)

But **couldn't** (negative) is different from **may not** and **might not**. Compare:

- ☐ Sarah **couldn't have received** my message. Otherwise she would have replied.
(= it is not possible that she got my message)
- ☐ Why hasn't Sarah replied to my message? I suppose she **might not have received** it.
(= it's possible that she didn't receive it – perhaps she did, perhaps she didn't)

Exercises

29.1 Complete the sentences. Choose from the box.

- 1 A: Do you know where Helen is?
B: I'm not sure. She might be in her room.
- 2 A: Is there a bookshop near here?
B: I'm not sure, but ask Anna. She
- 3 A: Where are those people from?
B: I don't know. They
- 4 A: I hope you can help me.
B: I'll try, but it
- 5 A: Whose phone is this?
B: It's not mine. It
- 6 A: Why doesn't George answer his phone?
B: He
- 7 A: Do you know anyone who has a key to this cupboard?
B: Rachel, but I'm not sure.
- 8 A: Gary is in a strange mood today.
B: Yes, he is. He

may be Tom's
may not be feeling well
may not be possible
~~might be in her room~~
might be Brazilian
might be driving
might have one
might know

29.2 Complete each sentence using the verb in brackets.

- 1 A: Where's Ben?
B: I'm not sure. He might be having lunch. (have)
- 2 A: Who was the guy we saw with Anna yesterday?
B: I'm not sure. It may her brother. (be)
- 3 A: Is Ellie here?
B: I can't see her. She may not yet. (arrive)
- 4 A: Gary said he would meet us in the cafe, but he isn't here.
B: He might outside. I'll go and look. (wait)
- 5 A: How did John know that I'd lost my job?
B: I don't know. I suppose Sam may him. (tell)
- 6 A: Do you know where Jeff is? Is he still in the office?
B: He was here earlier, but he might home. (go)
- 7 A: Where's Emma? What's she doing?
B: I'm not sure. She might TV. (watch)
- 8 A: Does Max have any brothers or sisters?
B: I'm not sure. I think he may a younger sister. (have)
- 9 A: I can't find my umbrella. Have you seen it?
B: You may it in the restaurant last night. (leave)
- 10 A: I rang Dan's doorbell, but he didn't answer. I'm sure he was there.
B: He might not the doorbell. (hear)
- 11 A: Hannah is supposed to meet us here, and she's already 20 minutes late.
B: She may She's always forgetting things. (forget)

29.3 Complete the sentences using **might not have ...** or **couldn't have ...**.

- 1 A: I was surprised Amy wasn't at the meeting. Perhaps she didn't know about it.
B: Maybe. She might not have known about it.
- 2 A: I wonder why Tom didn't come to the party. Perhaps he didn't want to come.
B: It's possible. He to come.
- 3 A: I wonder how the fire started. Was it an accident?
B: No, the police say it an accident. It was deliberate.
- 4 A: Mike says he needs to see you. He tried to find you yesterday.
B: Well, he very hard. I was in my office all day.
- 5 A: The man you spoke to – are you sure he was American?
B: No, I'm not sure. He

A

We use **may** and **might** to talk about possible actions or happenings in the future:

- ☐ I haven't decided where to go on holiday. I **may go** to Ireland. (= perhaps I will go there)
- ☐ Take an umbrella with you. It **might rain** later. (= perhaps it will rain)
- ☐ The bus isn't always on time. We **might have** to wait a few minutes. (= perhaps we will have to wait)

The negative forms are **may not** and **might not (mightn't)**:

- ☐ Amy **may not go** out tonight. She isn't feeling well. (= perhaps she will not go out)
- ☐ There **might not be** enough time to discuss everything at the meeting. (= perhaps there will not be enough time)

Compare:

- ☐ I'm **going** to buy a car. (for sure)
- ☐ I **may buy** a car. or I **might buy** a car. (possible)

B

Usually you can use **may** or **might**. So you can say:

- ☐ I **may go** to Ireland. or I **might go** to Ireland.
- ☐ Jane **might be** able to help you. or Jane **may be** able to help you.

But we use **might (not may)** when the situation is *not real*:

- ☐ If they paid me better, I **might** work harder. (*not* I may work)

This situation (**If they paid** me better) is not real. They do *not* pay me well, so I'm not going to work harder.

C

Compare **may/might be -ing** and **will be -ing**:

- ☐ Don't phone at 8.30. I'll **be watching** the football on TV.
- ☐ Don't phone at 8.30. I **might be watching** the football on TV. (= perhaps I'll be watching it)

We also use **may/might be -ing** for possible plans. Compare:

- ☐ I'm **going** to Ireland soon. (for sure)
- ☐ I **might be going** (or I **may be going**) to Ireland soon. (possible)

D

might as well

Helen and Clare have just missed the bus.
The buses run every hour.

What shall we do? Shall we walk?

We **might as well**. It's a nice day and I don't want to wait here for an hour.

We **might as well** do something = we should do it because there is no better alternative.
There is no reason not to do it.

You can also use **may as well**.



- ☐ A: What time are you going out?
B: Well, I'm ready, so I **might as well go** now. or ... I **may as well go** now.
- ☐ Buses are so expensive these days, you **might as well get** a taxi. (= taxis are as good, no more expensive than buses)

Exercises

30.1 Which alternative makes sense?

- A: Where are you going for your holidays?
B: I haven't decided yet. I might go / ~~I'm going~~ to Ireland. (I might go makes sense)
- A: Have you decided what sort of car you want to buy?
B: Yes, I might get / I'm going to get a sports car.
- A: When is Tom coming to see us?
B: He hasn't said yet. He might come / He's coming on Sunday.
- A: Where are you going to put that picture?
B: I don't know yet. I might hang / I'm going to hang it in the bedroom.
- A: What's Tanya going to do when she leaves school? Does she know yet?
B: Yes, she's decided. She might go / She's going to university.
- A: Do you have plans for the weekend?
B: Nothing fixed. I might go away / I'm going away.

30.2 Complete the sentences using **might** + a verb from the box:

- Take an umbrella with you when you go out. It might rain later.
- Don't make too much noise. You the baby.
- Be careful with your coffee. You it.
- Don't forget your phone. You it.
- It's better if we don't talk so loud. Somebody us.
- Be careful. This footpath is icy. You

hear
need
~~rain~~
slip
spill
wake

30.3 Complete the sentences. Use **might be able to** or **might have to** + one of these verbs:

fix ~~help~~ leave meet pay wait

- Tell me about your problem. I might be able to help you.
- I can come to the meeting, but I before the end.
- I'm not free this evening, but I you tomorrow evening.
- I'm not sure whether this car park is free or not. We
- There's a long queue. We a long time.
- 'I've got a problem with my bike.' 'Let me have a look. I it.'

30.4 Write sentences with **might not**.

- Lisa's not feeling very well. I'm not sure that she will go to the party.
Lisa might not come to the party.
- I haven't seen him for a long time. I don't know if I will recognise him or not.
I might him.
- We want to go to the game, but I don't know whether we'll be able to get tickets.
We for the game.
- I said I'd do the shopping, but it's possible I won't have time.
I to do the shopping.
- I've been invited to the wedding, but I'm not sure that I'll be able to go.
I

30.5 Read the situations and write sentences with **might as well**.

- You and a friend have just missed the bus. The buses run every hour.
You say: We'll have to wait an hour for the next bus. We might as well walk.
- Your computer doesn't work any more. It will cost a lot to repair.
You say: It's not worth repairing. I a new one.
- You've painted the kitchen. You still have a lot of paint, so why not paint the bathroom too?
You say: I too. There's plenty of paint left.
- You and a friend are at home. You're bored. There's a film on TV starting in a few minutes.
You say: We it. There's nothing else to do.

A

I **have to** do something = it is necessary to do it, I am obliged to do it:

- ☐ You can't turn right here. You **have to turn** left.
- ☐ I **have to wear** glasses for reading.
- ☐ Robert can't come out with us this evening. He **has to work** late.
- ☐ Last week Tina broke her arm and **had to go** to hospital.
- ☐ I haven't **had to go** to the doctor for ages.

You **have to turn** left here.



We use **do/does/did** in questions and negative sentences (for the present and past simple):

- ☐ What **do I have to do** to get a new driving licence? (*not* What have I to do?)
- ☐ Karen **doesn't have to work** Saturdays. (*not* Karen hasn't to)
- ☐ 'Did you **have to wait** a long time for a bus?' 'No, only ten minutes.'

You can say **I'll have to ... , I'm going to have to ... , I might have to ... , I may have to ...**:

- ☐ They can't repair my computer, so **I'll have to buy** a new one. *or* ... **I'm going to have to buy** a new one.
- ☐ We **might have to change** our plans. *or* We **may have to change** ... (= it's possible that we will have to change them)

B

Must is similar to **have to**. You can say:

- ☐ It's later than I thought. I **must go**. *or* I **have to go**.

You can use **must** or **have to** when you give your own opinion (for example, to say what *you* think is necessary, or to recommend someone to do something):

- ☐ I haven't spoken to Sue for ages. I **must phone** her. / I **have to phone** her. (= I say this is necessary)
- ☐ Mark is a really nice person. You **must meet** him. / You **have to meet** him. (= I recommend this)

We use **have to** (*not usually must*) to say what someone is *obliged* to do. This is a *fact*, not the speaker's own opinion:

- ☐ I **have to work** from 8.30 to 5.30 every day. (a fact, not an opinion)
- ☐ Jane **has to travel** a lot for her work.

But we use **must** in written rules and instructions:

- ☐ Applications for the job **must be received** by 18 May.
- ☐ Seat belts **must be worn**.

We use **had to** (*not must*) to talk about the past:

- ☐ I went to the meeting yesterday, but I **had** to leave early. (*not* I must)



C

Mustn't and **don't have to** are completely different:

You **mustn't** do something = *don't* do it:

- ☐ You **must keep** this a secret. You **mustn't tell** anyone. (= don't tell anyone)
- ☐ I promised I would be on time. I **mustn't be** late. (= I must be on time)

You **don't have to** do something = you don't need to do it (but you can if you want):

- ☐ You **don't have to come** with me. I can go alone.
- ☐ I **don't have to be** at the meeting, but I'm going anyway.

D

You can use **have got to** instead of **have to**. You can say:

- ☐ I've **got to** work tomorrow. *or* I **have to** work tomorrow.
- ☐ When **has** Helen **got to** go? *or* When **does** Helen **have to** go?

Exercises

31.1 Complete the sentences using **have/has/had to ...**. Use the verbs in brackets.

- Robert can't come out with us this evening. He has to work late. (he / work)
- 'The bus was late this morning.' 'How long did you have to wait?' (you / wait)
- I don't have much time. in ten minutes. (I / go)
- 'I'm afraid I can't stay long.' 'What time?' (you / go)
- Joe starts work at 5 am every day, which means at four. (he / get up)
- We nearly missed the bus this morning. to catch it. (we / run)
- Is Lisa usually free on Saturdays or? (she / work)
- There was nobody to help me. everything by myself. (I / do)
- How old to have a driving licence? (you / be)
- There was a lot of noise from the street. the window. (we / close)
- Was the exhibition free, or to go in? (you / pay)

31.2 Complete the sentences using **have/has/had to** + the verbs in the list. Some sentences are negative (**I don't have to ...** etc.):

ask decide drive ~~get up~~ go make make pay ~~show~~ stand

- I'm not working tomorrow, so I don't have to get up early.
- Steve didn't know how to change the settings on his phone. I had to show him.
- Excuse me a moment – I a phone call. I won't be long.
- You can let me know later what you want to do. You now.
- I couldn't find the street I wanted. I somebody for directions.
- This car park is free. You
- A man was slightly injured in the accident, but he to hospital.
- Jane has a senior position in the company. She important decisions.
- The train was very full and there were no seats free. We all the way.
- When Patrick starts his new job next month, he 50 miles to work every day.

31.3 In some of these sentences, **must** is wrong or unnatural. Correct the sentences where necessary.

- It's later than I thought. I must go. OK (I have to go is also correct)
- I must start work every day at 8.30. I have to start work
- I must remember to call Sarah tomorrow.
- I couldn't get a taxi last night. I must walk home.
- You must come and see us again soon.
- Tom isn't going out this evening. He must study for his exam.
- We can't go the usual way because the road is closed. We must go another way.
- Julia wears glasses. She must wear glasses since she was very young.

31.4 Complete the sentences with **mustn't**, **don't have to** or **doesn't have to**.

- I don't want anyone to know about our plan. You mustn't tell anyone.
- Richard doesn't have to wear a suit to work, but he usually does.
- There's a lift in the building, so we climb the stairs.
- I promised Kate I'd call her tomorrow. I forget.
- I'm not very busy. I have a few things to do, but I do them now.
- Sophie likes weekends because she get up early.
- You be a good player to enjoy a game of tennis.
- You should keep trying to find a job. You give up.
- I eat too much. I'm supposed to be on a diet.
- We have plenty of time before our flight. We check in yet.

A must and mustn't

You **must** do something = it is necessary that you do it:

- ☐ Don't tell anybody what I said. You **must keep** it a secret.
- ☐ We don't have much time. We **must hurry**.

You **mustn't** do something = don't do it:

- ☐ You **must** keep it a secret. You **mustn't** tell anyone. (= don't tell anyone)
- ☐ We **must** be very quiet. We **mustn't** make any noise.

B needn't and don't need to

You **needn't** do something = it's not necessary to do it (but you can if you want):

- ☐ We have plenty of time. We **needn't hurry**. (= it is not necessary to hurry)
- ☐ Joe can stay here. He **needn't come** with us. (= it is not necessary for him to come)

You can also use **don't/doesn't need to**:

- ☐ We **don't need to** hurry.

Note that we say '**don't need to** do', but '**needn't do**' (*without to*).

Compare **needn't** and **mustn't**:

- ☐ You **needn't** tell Steve. I can tell him myself. (= it is not necessary)
- ☐ You **mustn't** tell Steve. I don't want him to know. (= don't tell him)

C needn't have (done)

Study this example situation:



Paul and Sarah reserved a table at a restaurant.

But when they went to the restaurant, it was almost empty.

They **needn't have reserved** a table.

This means: they reserved a table, but now they know this was not necessary.

Compare **needn't** (do) and **needn't have** (done):

- ☐ Everything will be OK. You **needn't worry**. (it is not necessary)
- ☐ Everything was OK. You **needn't have worried**. (you worried, but it was not necessary)

D needn't have (done) and didn't need to (do)

He **needn't have done** something = he did it, but now we know that it was not necessary:

- ☐ Why did he get up at 5 o'clock? He **needn't have got** up so early. He could have stayed in bed longer.

He **didn't need to do** something = it was not necessary to do it. It doesn't matter whether he did it or not:

- ☐ He **didn't need to get** up early, so he didn't.
- ☐ He **didn't need to get** up early, but it was a beautiful morning, so he did.

You can also say 'He **didn't have to** get up' in these examples.

Exercises

32.1 Which goes with which? Find the sentences with a similar meaning.

- 1 You must be very quiet.
- 2 You must remember your password.
- 3 You must be brave.
- 4 You must be on time.
- 5 You must leave the furniture as it is.
- 6 You must go away.
- 7 You must forget what happened.

- a You mustn't stay here.
- b You mustn't be afraid.
- c You mustn't think about it.
- d You mustn't forget it.
- e You mustn't be late.
- f ~~You mustn't make any noise.~~
- g You mustn't move anything.

- 1 f
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- 6
- 7

32.2 Which is correct?

- 1 We have plenty of time. We ~~mustn't~~ / needn't hurry. (needn't is correct)
- 2 I have to talk to Gary. I must / ~~mustn't~~ remember to call him.
- 3 I have to talk to Gary. I ~~mustn't~~ / needn't forget to call him.
- 4 There's plenty of time for you to decide. You ~~mustn't~~ / don't need to decide now.
- 5 These are important documents. We ~~mustn't~~ / needn't lose them.
- 6 You ~~mustn't~~ / needn't wait for me. You go on and I'll join you later.
- 7 This is a dangerous situation and we need to be careful. We ~~mustn't~~ / needn't do anything stupid.
- 8 I understand the situation perfectly. You ~~mustn't~~ / don't need to explain further.
- 9 A: What sort of house do you want to buy? Something big?
B: It ~~mustn't~~ / needn't be big – that's not so important. But it must / mustn't have a nice garden.

32.3 Complete the sentences. Use **needn't + verb**. Choose from:

come keep ~~leave~~ walk worry

- 1 We have plenty of time. We needn't leave yet.
- 2 I can manage the shopping alone. You with me.
- 3 We all the way home. We can get a taxi.
- 4 You can delete these emails. You them.
- 5 I'll be all right. You about me.

32.4 Write two sentences for each situation. Use **needn't have** in the first sentence and **could have** in the second (as in the example). For **could have**, see Unit 27.

- 1 Why did you rush? Why didn't you take your time?
You needn't have rushed. You could have taken your time.
- 2 Why did you walk home? Why didn't you take a taxi?
.....
- 3 Why did they stay at a hotel? Why didn't they stay with us?
.....
- 4 Why did she phone me at 3 am? Why didn't she wait until the morning?
.....
- 5 Why did you shout at me? Why weren't you more patient?
.....

32.5 Are these sentences OK? Change them where necessary.

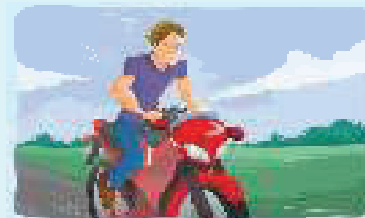
- 1 We have plenty of time. We don't need hurry. We don't need to hurry.
- 2 Keep it a secret. You mustn't tell anybody. OK
- 3 You needn't to shout. I can hear you perfectly.
- 4 I needn't have gone out, so I stayed at home.
- 5 This train is direct. You don't need to change.
- 6 You mustn't lock the door. It's OK to leave it unlocked.
- 7 I needn't have said anything, so I kept quiet.
- 8 I needn't have said anything. I should have kept quiet.

A

You **should do** something = it is a good thing to do or the right thing to do.

You can use **should** to give advice or to give an opinion:

- ☐ You look tired. You **should go** to bed.
- ☐ The government **should do** more to improve schools.
- ☐ A: **Should** we **invite** Stephanie to the party?
B: Yes, I think we **should**.
- ☐ The man on the motorbike **should be wearing** a helmet.



You **shouldn't** do something = it isn't a good thing to do:

- ☐ You **shouldn't believe** everything you read in newspapers.

We often use **should** with **I think / I don't think / Do you think ... ?**:

- ☐ **I think** the government **should do** more to improve schools.
- ☐ **I don't think** you **should work** so hard.
- ☐ A: **Do you think** I **should apply** for this job?
B: Yes, **I think** you **should**.

Should is not as strong as **must** or **have to**:

- ☐ You **should** apologise. (= it would be a good thing to do)
- ☐ You **must** apologise. / You **have to** apologise. (= you have no alternative)

B

We use **should** when something is not right or what we expect:

- ☐ Where's Tina? She **should be** here by now.
(= she isn't here yet, and this is not normal)
- ☐ The price on this packet is wrong. It **should be** £2.50, not £3.50.

We also use **should** to say that we expect something to happen:

- ☐ Helen has been studying hard for the exam, so she **should pass**.
(= I expect her to pass)
- ☐ There are plenty of hotels in the town. It **shouldn't be** hard to find a place to stay.
(= I don't expect it to be hard)

C

You **should have done** something = you didn't do it, but it would have been a good thing to do:

- ☐ You missed a great party last night. You **should have come**. Why didn't you?
(= you didn't come, but it would have been good to come)
- ☐ I wonder why they're so late. They **should have been** here long ago.

You **shouldn't have done** something = you did it, but it wasn't a good thing to do:

- ☐ I'm feeling sick. I **shouldn't have eaten** so much. (= I ate too much)
- ☐ She **shouldn't have been listening** to our conversation. It was private.
(= she was listening)

Compare **should** (do) and **should have** (done):

- ☐ You look tired. You **should go** to bed now.
- ☐ You went to bed very late last night. You **should have gone** to bed earlier.

D

ought to ...

You can use **ought to** instead of **should** in the sentences on this page.

We say 'ought to do' (with **to**):

- ☐ Do you think I **ought to apply** for this job? (= Do you think I **should apply** ... ?)
- ☐ Jack **ought not to go** to bed so late. (= Jack **shouldn't go** ...)
- ☐ It was a great party last night. You **ought to have come**. (= You **should have come**)

Exercises

33.1 For each situation, write a sentence with **should** or **shouldn't** + one of the following:

~~go away for a few days~~
put some pictures on the walls

stay up so late
take a picture

look for another job
worry so much

- 1 Anna needs a change. She should go away for a few days.
- 2 Your salary is very low. You
- 3 Jack always finds it hard to get up. He
- 4 What a beautiful view! You
- 5 Laura is always anxious. She
- 6 Dan's room isn't very nice.

33.2 Complete the sentences. Choose from:

should solve
should receive

should be working OK
~~should pass the exam~~

shouldn't cost more
should be much warmer

shouldn't take long
should be here soon

- 1 Helen has been studying hard, so she should pass the exam.
- 2 Joe hasn't arrived yet, but he
- 3 The TV has been repaired. It now.
- 4 It to get to the hotel. About 20 minutes.
- 5 I sent the documents to you today, so you them tomorrow.
- 6 The weather is unusually cold. It at this time of year.
- 7 The best way to get to the airport is by taxi. It than ten pounds.
- 8 If you have a problem with the computer, try restarting it. That the problem.

33.3 Complete the sentences. Use **should ...** or **should have ...** + the verb in brackets.

- 1 You look tired. You should go to bed. (go)
- 2 You missed a great party last night. You should have come. (come)
- 3 I'm in a difficult position. What do you think I now? (do)
- 4 I'm sorry that I didn't take your advice. I what you said. (do)
- 5 We lost the game, but we were the better team. We (win)
- 6 We don't see you enough. You and see us more often. (come)
- 7 We went the wrong way and got lost. We right, not left. (turn)
- 8 My exam results weren't good. I better. (do)

33.4 Read the situations and write sentences with **should** / **should have** / **shouldn't** / **shouldn't have**.

- 1 I'm feeling sick. I ate too much.
I shouldn't have eaten so much.
- 2 When we got to the restaurant, there were no free tables. We hadn't reserved one.
We
- 3 Laura told me her address, but I didn't write it down. Now I can't remember the house number.
I
- 4 The shop is open every day from 8.30. It is 9 o'clock now, but the shop isn't open yet.
.....
- 5 I was looking at my phone. I wasn't looking where I was going. I walked into a wall.
.....
- 6 Kate is driving. The speed limit is 30 miles an hour, but Kate is doing 50.
She
- 7 I wasn't feeling well yesterday, but I went to work. That was a mistake. Now I feel worse.
.....
- 8 Tomorrow there is a football match between Team A and Team B. Team A are much better.
.....
- 9 I was driving. The car in front stopped suddenly and I drove into it. It wasn't my fault.
The driver in front

A You can use **should** after:

insist demand recommend suggest propose

- ☐ I **insisted** that he **should apologise**.
- ☐ Doctors **recommend** that everyone **should eat** plenty of fruit.
- ☐ What do you **suggest** we **should do**?
- ☐ Many people are **demanding** that something **should be done** about the problem.

also

It's important/vital/necessary/essential that ... **should** ...:

- ☐ **It's essential** that everyone **should be** here on time.

B You can also leave out **should** in the sentences in section A. So you can say:

- ☐ **It's essential** that everyone **be** here on time. (= ... that everyone **should be** here ...)
- ☐ I **insisted** that he **apologise**. (= ... that he **should apologise**)
- ☐ What do you **suggest** we **do**?
- ☐ Many people are **demanding** that something **be done** about the problem.

This form (**be/do/apologise** etc.) is called the *subjunctive*. It is the same as the *infinitive* (without **to**).

You can also use normal present and past forms:

- ☐ It's **essential** that everyone **is** here on time.
- ☐ I **insisted** that he **apologised**.

C We do not use **to** ... with **suggest**. You can say:

- ☐ What do you **suggest we should do**?
- or What do you **suggest we do**? (*but not* What do you suggest us to do?)
- ☐ Jane won the lottery.
- I **suggested** that she **should buy** a car with the money she won.
- or I **suggested** that she **buy** a car.
- or I **suggested** that she **bought** a car. (*but not* I suggested her to buy)

You can also use **-ing** after **suggest** (What do you **suggest doing**?). See Unit 53.

D You can use **should** after some adjectives, especially:

strange odd funny typical natural interesting surprised surprising

- ☐ It's **strange** that he **should be** late. He's usually on time.
- ☐ I was **surprised** that he **should say** such a thing.

E You can say **'if something should happen ...'**. For example:

- ☐ We have no jobs at present, but **if the situation should change**, we will contact you.

You can also begin with **should** (**Should** something happen ...):

- ☐ **Should** the situation **change**, we will contact you.

This means the same as **'If the situation changes, ...'**. With **should**, the speaker feels that the possibility is smaller.

F You can use **I should ... / I shouldn't ...** to give advice. For example:

- ☐ 'Shall I leave now?' 'No, **I should wait** a bit.' (= I advise you to wait)

Here, **I should ...** = 'I would ... if I were you', 'I advise you to ...'. Two more examples:

- ☐ 'I'm going out now. Is it cold outside?' 'Yes, **I should wear** a coat.'
- ☐ **I shouldn't stay** up too late. You have to be up early tomorrow.

Exercises

34.1 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first.

- 'It would be a good idea to eat more fruit,' the doctor said to me.
The doctor recommended that I should eat more fruit.
- 'You really must stay a little longer,' she said to me.
She insisted that I
- 'Why don't you visit the museum after lunch?' I said to them.
I suggested that
- 'You must pay the rent by Friday,' the landlord said to us.
The landlord demanded that
- 'Let's go to the cinema,' Chris said to me.
Chris suggested that

34.2 Two of these sentences are not correct. Change the two that are not correct.

- Tom suggested that I look for another job. OK
- I called Tina and suggested that we meet for coffee.
- What do you suggest me to do?
- What sort of car do you suggest I should buy?
- I suggest you to read this book.
- I suggested that Anna learn to drive.

34.3 Complete the sentences using **should + verb. Choose from:**ask ~~be~~ be done leave say vote worry

- It's strange that he should be late. He's usually on time.
- It's funny that you that. I was thinking the same thing.
- It's only natural that parents about their children.
- Isn't it typical of Joe that he without saying goodbye to anybody?
- I was surprised that they me for advice. What advice could I give them?
- This is a democratic election, and it's important that you
- The bridge needs to be repaired. It's essential that the work as soon as possible.

34.4 Complete the sentences using **If ... should Choose from:**anyone / ask ~~the situation / change~~ it / rain there / any problems

- We have no jobs at present. If the situation should change, we'll let you know.
- I've hung out the washing to dry on the balcony. If, can you bring it inside?
- I think everything will be OK., I'm sure we'll be able to solve them.
- I don't want anyone to know where I'm going., say you don't know.

Now complete the same sentences beginning with **Should**

- Should the situation change, we'll let you know.
-, can you bring the washing inside?
-, I'm sure we'll be able to solve them.
- where I'm going, say you don't know.

34.5 Complete the sentences using **I should. Choose from:**call get keep ~~wait~~

- 'Shall I leave now?' 'No, I should wait a bit.'
- 'Shall I throw these things away?' 'No, them. You may need them.'
- 'Shall I go and see Paul?' 'Yes, but him first.'
- 'Is it worth getting this computer repaired?' 'No, a new one.'

I'd better ... it's time ...

A had better (I'd better / you'd better etc.)

I'd better do something = it is advisable to do it. If I don't do it, there will be a problem or a danger:

- ☐ I have to meet Amy in ten minutes. **I'd better go** now or I'll be late.
- ☐ 'Shall I take an umbrella?' 'Yes, **you'd better**. It might rain.'
- ☐ **We'd better stop** for petrol soon. The tank is almost empty.

The negative is **I'd better not** (= I **had** better not):

- ☐ A: That jacket looks good on you. Are you going to buy it?
B: **I'd better not**. It's very expensive.
- ☐ You don't look very well. **You'd better not go** out tonight.

Remember that:

I'd better = I **had** better, **you'd better** = you **had** better etc.

- ☐ **I'd better** phone Chris, **hadn't I**?
- ☐ We **had better** go now.

Had is normally past, but we use **had better** for the present or future, *not* past.

- ☐ I'd better go **now** / **tomorrow**.

We say 'I'd better **do**' (*not* to do).

- ☐ It might rain. We'd better **take** an umbrella. (*not* We'd better to take)

B had better and should

Had better is similar to **should** but not exactly the same. We use **had better** only for a specific situation, not for things in general. You can use **should** in all types of situations to give an opinion or give advice:

- ☐ It's late. **You'd better go**. or You **should go**. (a specific situation)
- ☐ You're always at home. You **should go** out more often. (in general – *not* 'had better go')

Also, with **had better**, there is always a danger or a problem if you don't follow the advice.

Should means only 'it is a good thing to do'. Compare:

- ☐ It's a great film. You **should** go and see it. (but no problem if you don't)
- ☐ The film starts at 8.30. **You'd better** go now or you'll miss the beginning.

C it's time ...

You can say **It's time** (for somebody) **to** ...:

- ☐ It's time **to go** home. / It's time for us **to go** home.

But you can also say:

- ☐ It's late. It's time **we went** home.

When we use **it's time** + past ('it's time we **went**' etc.), the meaning is present, *not* past:

- ☐ **It's time** they **were** here. Why are they so late? (*not* It's time they are here)

It's time somebody **did** something = they should have already done it or started it.

We often use this structure to criticise or to complain:

- ☐ This situation can't continue. **It's time** you **did** something about it.
- ☐ He's very selfish. **It's time** he **realised** that he isn't the most important person in the world.

You can also say **It's about time** ...:

- ☐ Jack is a great talker, but **it's about time** he **did** something instead of just talking.

Exercises

35.1 Read the situations and write sentences with **'d better** or **'d better not**. Choose a verb from:

check disturb go put reserve ~~take~~

- You're going out for a walk with a friend. It looks as if it might rain.
You say: We'd better take an umbrella.
- You and Kate plan to go to a restaurant tonight. It will be busy.
You say to Kate: We a table.
- Oliver has just cut himself. It's bleeding and he'll need a plaster on it.
You say to him: You on it.
- Rebecca doesn't look well this morning – not well enough to go to work.
You say to her: this morning.
- You're going to the cinema, but you're not sure what time the film starts.
You say: the film starts.
- You need to talk to your boss, but she's very busy right now.
You say to a colleague: right now.

35.2 Is **had better** OK in these sentences? Change to **should** where necessary.

- I have an appointment in ten minutes. I'd better go now or I'll be late. OK
- You'd better set your alarm. You have to get up early tomorrow.
- I'm glad you came to see us. You'd better come more often.
- She'll be sad if we don't invite her to the party, so we'd better invite her.
- It's nearly time to go out. I'd better get ready.
- I think everybody had better learn a foreign language.
- We've just missed the last bus. We'd better get a taxi.

35.3 Complete the sentences. Choose from the box.

- It might rain. We'd better take an umbrella.
- Ben needs to know what happened. Somebody better tell him.
- We'd better park the car here. The road is too narrow.
- You brush your teeth at least twice a day.
- What are we going to do? It's time decide.
- better not be late. It's an important meeting.
- It's time they here. They promised they wouldn't be late.
- The window is open. You'd close it before you go out.
- We'd better leave as soon as possible, we?
- The government should something about the problem.
- It's time the government something about the problem.
- It's time something done about the problem.

better
do
did
had
hadn't
I'd
not
to
~~**take**~~
should
was
were

35.4 Read the situations and write sentences with **It's time** (somebody **did** something).

- You're at a friend's house. You planned to go home at 11 o'clock. It's already 11 o'clock now.
(I / go) It's time I went home.
- You haven't had a holiday for a very long time. You need one now.
(I / holiday) It's time
- It's 10 o'clock. It's after the children's bedtime. You think they should be in bed.
(children / bed)
- You didn't realise it was so late. You need to start cooking dinner.
(start / cook) dinner.
- Kate is always complaining about everything. You think she complains too much.
(stop / complaining) about everything.
- The company you work for has been badly managed for a long time. You think some changes should be made.
(changes / make) in the way the company is run.

A

We use **would** ('d) / **wouldn't** when we *imagine* a situation or action (= we think of something that is not real):

- ☐ It **would be** nice to buy a new car, but we can't afford it.
- ☐ I'd **love** to live by the sea.
- ☐ A: Shall I tell Chris what happened?
B: No, I **wouldn't say** anything.
(= I wouldn't say anything in your situation)



We use **would have (done)** when we imagine something that didn't happen in the past:

- ☐ They helped us a lot. I don't know what we'd **have done** without their help.
(we'd have done = we **would** have done)
- ☐ It's a shame you didn't see the film. You **would have liked** it.
- ☐ I didn't tell Sam what happened. He **wouldn't have been** pleased.

Compare **would (do)** and **would have (done)**:

- ☐ I **would call** Lisa, but I don't have her number. (*now*)
I **would have called** Lisa, but I didn't have her number. (*past*)
- ☐ I'm not going to invite them to the party. They **wouldn't come** anyway.
I didn't invite them to the party. They **wouldn't have come** anyway.

We often use **would** in sentences with **if** (see Units 38–40):

- ☐ I **would call** Lisa **if** I had her number.
- ☐ I **would have called** Lisa **if** I'd had her number.

B

Compare **will ('ll)** and **would ('d)**:

- ☐ I'll **stay** a little longer. I've got plenty of time.
I'd **stay** a little longer, but I really have to go now. (so I can't stay longer)
- ☐ I'll **call** Lisa. I have her number.
I'd **call** Lisa, but I don't have her number. (so I can't call her)

Sometimes **would/wouldn't** is the past of **will/won't**.

Compare:

<i>present</i>		<i>past</i>
☐ TOM: I'll call you on Sunday.	→	Tom said he'd call me on Sunday.
☐ AMY: I promise I won't be late.	→	Amy promised that she wouldn't be late.
☐ LISA: Oh, no! The car won't start .	→	Lisa was annoyed because her car wouldn't start .

Somebody **wouldn't do** something = he/she refused to do it:

- ☐ I tried to warn him, but he **wouldn't listen** to me. (= he refused to listen)
- ☐ The car **wouldn't start**. (= it 'refused' to start)

C

You can also use **would** to talk about things that happened regularly in the past:

- ☐ When we were children, we lived by the sea. In summer, if the weather was fine, we **would** all get up early and go for a swim. (= we did this regularly)
- ☐ Whenever Richard was angry, he **would** walk out of the room.

With this meaning, **would** is similar to **used to** (see Unit 18):

- ☐ Whenever Richard was angry, he **used to walk** out of the room.

Exercises

36.1 Write sentences about yourself. Imagine things you would like or wouldn't like.

- 1 (a place you'd love to live) *I'd love to live by the sea.*
- 2 (a job you wouldn't like to do)
- 3 (something you would love to do)
- 4 (something that would be nice to have)
- 5 (a place you'd like to go to)

36.2 Complete the sentences using *would* + the following verbs (in the correct form):

be be do do enjoy enjoy have stop

- 1 They helped us a lot. I don't know what we *would have done* without their help.
- 2 You should go and see the film. I think you it.
- 3 It's a pity you couldn't come to the party last night. You it.
- 4 Shall I apply for the job or not? What you in my position?
- 5 I was in a hurry when I saw you. Otherwise I to talk.
- 6 We took a taxi home last night, but got stuck in the traffic. It quicker to walk.
- 7 Why don't you go and see Clare? She very pleased to see you.
- 8 In an ideal world, everybody enough to eat.

36.3 Each sentence on the right follows a sentence on the left. Which follows which?

- 1 I'd like to go to Australia one day.
- 2 I wouldn't like to live on a busy road.
- 3 I'm sorry your trip was cancelled.
- 4 I'm looking forward to going out tonight.
- 5 I'm glad we didn't go out in the rain.
- 6 I'm not looking forward to the trip.

- a It wouldn't have been very nice.
- b It would have been fun.
- c ~~It would be nice.~~
- d It won't be much fun.
- e It wouldn't be very nice.
- f It will be fun.

- 1 *c*
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- 6

36.4 Write sentences using *promised* + *would*/*wouldn't*.

- 1 I wonder why Laura is late. *She promised she wouldn't be late.*
- 2 I wonder why Steve hasn't called me. He promised
- 3 Why did you tell Amy what I said? You
- 4 I'm surprised they didn't wait for us. They

36.5 Complete the sentences. Use *wouldn't* + a suitable verb.

- 1 I tried to warn him, but he *wouldn't listen* to me.
- 2 I asked Amanda what had happened, but she me.
- 3 Paul was angry about what I'd said and he to me for two weeks.
- 4 Martina insisted on carrying all her luggage. She me help her.

36.6 Complete the sentences using *would* (section C). Choose from these verbs:

forget shake share smile stay ~~walk~~

- 1 Whenever Richard was angry, he *would walk* out of the room.
- 2 We used to live next to a railway line. Every time a train went past, the house
- 3 Katherine was always very generous. She didn't have much, but she what she had with everyone else.
- 4 You could never rely on Joe. It didn't matter how many times you reminded him to do something, he always
- 5 When we were children, we used to go to the beach a lot. We there all day playing in the sand and swimming in the sea.
- 6 Lucy was always friendly. Whenever I saw her, she always and say hello.

can/could/would you ... ? etc. (Requests, offers, permission and invitations)

A Asking people to do things (requests)

We use **can** or **could** to ask people to do things:

- ☐ **Can you** wait a moment, please?
- or ☐ **Could you** wait a moment, please?
- ☐ Helen, **can you** do me a favour?
- ☐ Excuse me, **could you** tell me how to get to the bus station?

You can say **Do you think you could** ... ? :

- ☐ **Do you think you could** take me to the airport?
(not Do you think you can)

Could you open the door, please?



B Asking for things

To ask for something, we use **Can (I) have ... ? / Could (I) have ... ?** or **Can (I) get ... ?**:

- ☐ (in a shop) **Can I have** these postcards, please? or **Can I get** these postcards, please?
- ☐ (in a restaurant) **Could we have** the menu, please? or **Can we have** the menu, please?

May I have ... ? is also possible:

- ☐ **May I have** these postcards, please?

C Asking to do things

We use **can I** or **could I** to ask to do something:

- ☐ (on the phone) Hello, **can I** speak to Steve, please?
- ☐ **'Could I** use your phone charger?' 'Sure.'
- ☐ **Do you think I could** borrow your bike?

May is also possible:

- ☐ **May I ask you a question?**

May is more formal than **can** or **could**.

You can also say:

- Do you mind if I ... ?**
- Is it all right if I ... ? / Is it OK if I ... ?**
- ☐ **Do you mind if I** use your phone charger?
- ☐ **'Is it all right if I** sit here?' 'Yes, of course.'

Could I use your phone charger?



D Offering and inviting

You can use **Can I ... ?** to offer to do something:

- ☐ **'Can I** help you?' 'No, it's OK. I can manage, thanks.'
- ☐ **'Can I** get you some coffee?' 'That would be nice.'

To offer or to invite, we use **Would you like ... ?** (not Do you like):

- ☐ **'Would you like** some coffee?' 'No, thanks.'
- ☐ **'Would you like** to eat with us tonight?' 'That would be great.'

I'd like ... (= I would like) is a polite way to say what you want:

- ☐ (at a tourist information office) **I'd like** some information about hotels, please.
- ☐ (in a shop) **I'd like** to try on this jacket, please.

Exercises

37.1 Which goes with which?

- 1 Could you pass the sugar?
- 2 Would you like to go to the cinema?
- 3 Can I use your toilet?
- 4 Do you mind if I leave work early?
- 5 Can you do me a favour?
- 6 Would you like something to eat?
- 7 Can I give you a hand?
- 8 I'd like some fresh air.

- a It depends what you want me to do.
- b No, that's fine.
- c Me too. Let's go out for a walk.
- d Sure. It's the door on the left.
- e ~~Yes, here you are.~~
- f No, it's all right. I can manage, thanks.
- g Maybe. What's on?
- h No, thanks. I'm not hungry.

- 1 e
- 2
- 3
- 4
- 5
- 6
- 7
- 8

37.2 Complete the sentences. Choose from:

I'd like

~~Can I give~~

Would you like to try

Would you like to come

Do you mind

Would you like

Can I take

I'd like to

- 1 You're driving and you see a friend walking along the road. You stop and say:
Hi Joe. Can I give you a lift?
- 2 You're making a cold drink for your friend. Perhaps he wants ice. You ask:
..... ice in your drink?
- 3 You're ordering something to eat in a cafe. You say:
..... a chicken salad, please.
- 4 You have an extra ticket for a concert. Maybe your friend will come. You ask:
..... to a concert tomorrow night?
- 5 You answer the phone. The caller wants to speak to Lisa. You say:
Lisa's not here. a message?
- 6 You need to see a dentist. You phone for an appointment. You say:
Hello. make an appointment, please.
- 7 You work in a shoe shop. A customer asks you about some shoes. You ask:
..... them on?
- 8 You go into a cafe and see some people you know. You ask:
..... if I join you?

37.3 What would you say in these situations?

- 1 You're carrying a lot of things. You can't open the door yourself. There's a man near the door.
You say to him: Could you open the door, please?
- 2 You've finished your meal in a restaurant and now you want the bill.
You ask the waiter:
- 3 You've filled in some forms in English. You want your friend to check them for you.
You ask your friend:
- 4 The woman in the next room is playing music. It's very loud. You want her to turn it down.
You say to her:
- 5 You're on a train. The window is open and you're cold. You'd like to close it.
You ask the man next to you:
- 6 You're on a bus. You have a seat, but an elderly man is standing. You offer him your seat.
You say to him:
- 7 You're a tourist. You want to go to the station, but you don't know how to get there.
You ask at your hotel:
- 8 You are in a clothes shop. You see some trousers you like and you want to try them on.
You say to the shop assistant:
- 9 You meet a very famous person. You want to get his/her autograph.
You ask:

if I do ... and if I did ...

A

Compare these examples:

- (1) LISA: Shall we take the bus or the train?
JESS: **If we take** the bus, it **will** be cheaper.

For Jess, it is possible that they will take the bus, so she says:

If we take the bus, it **will** be ...



- (2) Lisa and Jess decide to take the train.
Later, Jess talks to Joe.

JOE: How are you going to travel?

JESS: We're going to take the train. **If we took** the bus, it **would** be cheaper, but the train is quicker.

Now Jess knows they are *not* going to take the bus, so she says:

If we took the bus, it **would** be ...

If we took the bus, it would be cheaper.

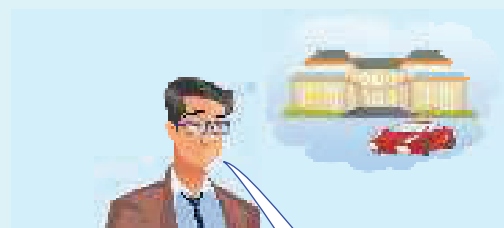


B

When we talk about something that will not happen, or we don't expect that it will happen, we use **if + past (if we went / if there was etc.)**.

But the meaning is *not* past:

- ☐ What would you do **if you won** a lot of money? (I don't really expect this to happen)
- ☐ **If there was** an election tomorrow, who would you vote for? (there will not be an election tomorrow)
- ☐ I'd be surprised **if they didn't come** to the party. (I expect them to come)



If I won a lot of money ...

Compare **if I find** and **if I found**:

- ☐ I think I left my watch at your house. **If you find** it, can you call me?
- but
- ☐ **If you found** a wallet in the street, what would you do with it?

C

We do not normally use **would** in the **if**-part of the sentence:

- ☐ I'd be very scared **if somebody pointed** a gun at me. (*not* if somebody would point)
- ☐ **If we went** by bus, it would be cheaper. (*not* If we would go)

In the other part of the sentence (not the **if**-part) we use **would ('d) / wouldn't**:

- ☐ I'd be (= I **would** be) scared if somebody pointed a gun at me.
- ☐ I'm not going to bed yet. I'm not tired. If I went to bed now, I **wouldn't sleep**.
- ☐ What **would** you **do** if you were bitten by a snake?

Could and **might** are also possible:

- ☐ If I won a lot of money, I **might** buy a house. (= it is possible that I would buy a house)
- ☐ If it stopped raining, we **could go** out. (= we would be able to go out)

Exercises

38.1 Complete the sentences. Choose from:

did dropped found happened lost was went

- If you found a wallet in the street, what would you do with it?
- Be careful with that vase. If you it, it would break into small pieces.
- This notebook is very important to me. I'd be very upset if I it.
- I don't expect to lose my job but if that, I'd have to find another one.
- We're thinking about our holiday for next year. If we to Italy, would you come with us?
- I don't think he'll fail the exam. I'd be very surprised if he
- If there a fire in the building, would you know how to put the fire out?

38.2 What do you say in these situations?

- Of course you don't expect to win the lottery. Which do you say?
 - If I win the lottery, I'll buy a big house. ☐
 - If I won the lottery, I'd buy a big house. ☒ (b is correct)
- You're not going to sell your car because it's old and not worth much. Which do you say?
 - If I sell my car, I won't get much money for it. ☐
 - If I sold my car, I wouldn't get much money for it. ☐
- You often see Sarah. A friend of yours wants to contact her. Which do you say?
 - If I see Sarah, I'll tell her to call you. ☐
 - If I saw Sarah, I'd tell her to call you. ☐
- You don't expect that there will be a fire in the building. Which do you say?
 - What will you do if there is a fire in the building? ☐
 - What would you do if there was a fire in the building? ☐
- You've never lost your passport. You can only imagine it.
 - I don't know what I'll do if I lose my passport. ☐
 - I don't know what I'd do if I lost my passport. ☐
- Somebody stops you and asks the way to a bank. Which do you say?
 - If you go right at the end of this street, you'll see a bank on your left. ☐
 - If you went right at the end of this street, you'd see a bank on your left. ☐
- You're in a lift. There is an emergency button. Nobody is going to press it. Which do you say?
 - What will happen if somebody presses that button? ☐
 - What would happen if somebody pressed that button? ☐

38.3 Complete the sentences.

- I'd be very scared if somebody pointed (somebody / point) a gun at me.
- I can't afford to buy a car. If (I / buy) a car, I'd have to borrow the money.
- If you had a party, who (you / invite)?
- Don't lend James your car. If (he / ask) me, I wouldn't lend him mine.
- I don't think Gary and Emma will get married. (I / be) amazed if they did.
- If (somebody / give) me \$20,000, (I / have) a long holiday.
- (you / be) nervous if (you / meet) a famous person?
- What (you / do) if (you / be) in a lift and (it / stop) between floors?

38.4 Write sentences beginning **If ...**.

- We're not going to take the 10.30 train. (we / arrive too early)
If we took the 10.30 train, we'd arrive too early.
- We're not going to stay at a hotel. (it / cost too much)
If we, it
- There's no point in telling you what happened. (you / not / believe)
If I
- Sally has no plans to leave her job. (it / hard to find another one)
If she
- Kevin is not going to apply for the job. (he / not / get it).
.....

if I knew ... I wish I knew ...

A Study this example situation:

Sarah wants to phone Paul, but she can't do this because she doesn't know his number. She says:

I'd phone him **if I knew** his number.
(I'd phone = I **would** phone)

Sarah *doesn't* know Paul's number, so she says 'if I **knew**'.
She *imagines* what she **would** do **if** she **knew** his number.



... if I knew his number ...

When we imagine a situation like this, we use **if + past** (**if I knew** / **if you were** / **if we didn't** etc.).
But the meaning is present, *not* past:

- ☐ There are many things I'd like to do **if I had** more time. (but I don't have time)
- ☐ **If I didn't** want to go to the party, I wouldn't go. (but I want to go)
- ☐ **If you were** in my position, what would you do?
- ☐ It's a pity he can't drive. It would be useful **if he could**.

B We use the past in the same way after **wish** (**I wish I knew** / **I wish you were** etc.).

We use **wish** to say that we regret something, that something is not as we would like it to be:

- ☐ **I wish I knew** Paul's phone number.
(= I don't know it and I regret this)
- ☐ Do you ever **wish** you **could** fly?
(you can't fly)
- ☐ It's very crowded here. **I wish** there **weren't** so many people. (there are a lot of people)
- ☐ **I wish I didn't** have to work tomorrow, but unfortunately I do.

Compare:

- ☐ **I'm glad I live** here. (I live here and that's good)
- ☐ **I wish I lived** here. (I don't live here unfortunately)

C After **if** and **wish**, you can use **were** instead of **was** (**if I were** / **I wish it were** etc.).

You can also use **was**. So you can say:

- | | | |
|--|----|----------------------------------|
| ☐ If I were you, I wouldn't buy that coat. | or | If I was you, ... |
| ☐ I'd go for a walk if it weren't so cold. | or | ... if it wasn't so cold. |
| ☐ I wish Anna were here. | or | I wish Anna was here. |

D We do not usually say 'if ... would'. We use **would** ('d) in the other part of the sentence:

- ☐ **If I were** rich, I **would** travel a lot. (*not* If I would be rich)
- ☐ Who **would** you ask **if** you **needed** help? (*not* if you would need)

In the same way we say:

- ☐ **I wish I had** something to read. (*not* I wish I would have)
- ☐ **I wish she were** here now. (*not* I wish she would be)

For '**I wish ... would ...**' see Unit 41.

E **Could** sometimes means 'would be able to' and sometimes 'was/were able to':

- ☐ She **could get** a better job (she **could get** = she **would be able to** get)
if she **could speak** another language. (if she **could speak** = if she **was able to** speak)
- ☐ I wish I **could** help you. (I wish I **could** = I wish I **was able to**)

Exercises

39.1 Put the verb into the correct form.

- If I knew (I / know) his number, I would phone him.
- I wouldn't buy (I / not / buy) that coat if I were you.
- (I / help) you if I could, but I'm afraid I can't.
- This soup isn't very nice. (it / taste) better if it wasn't so salty.
- We live in a city and don't need a car, but we would need one if
(we / live) in the country.
- If we had the choice, (we / live) in the country.
- I'd make a lot of changes if (I / be) the manager of the company.
- I wouldn't call someone in the middle of the night if (it / not / be) important.
- If I were you, (I / not / wait). (I / go) now.
- You're always tired because you go to bed so late. If (you / not / go)
to bed so late every night, (you / not / be) tired all the time.
- I think there are too many cars. If (there / not / be) so many cars,
..... (there / not / be) so much pollution.
- We all need jobs and money, but what (you / do) if
..... (you / not / have) to work?

39.2 Write a sentence with **if ...** for each situation.

- We don't see you very often because you live so far away.
If you didn't live so far away, we'd see you more often.
- I like these shoes but they're too expensive, so I'm not going to buy them.
I them if so
- We'd like to go on holiday, but we can't afford it.
We if
- It would be nice to have lunch outside but it's raining, so we can't.
We
- I don't want his advice, and that's why I'm not going to ask for it.
If

39.3 Write sentences beginning **I wish ...**.

- I don't know many people (and I'm lonely). I wish I knew more people.
- I don't have much free time (and I need more). I wish
- Helen isn't here (and I need to see her).
- It's cold (and I hate cold weather).
- I live in a big city (and I don't like it).
- I can't find my phone (which is a problem).
- I'm not feeling well (which isn't good).
- I have to get up early tomorrow (but I'd prefer to sleep late).
.....
- I don't know much about science (and I should know more).
.....

39.4 Write your own sentences beginning **I wish ...**.

- (somewhere you'd like to be now – on the beach, in New York, in bed etc.)
I wish I
- (something you'd like to have – a motorbike, more friends, lots of money etc.)
.....
- (something you'd like to be able to do – sing, travel more, cook etc.)
.....
- (something you'd like to be – famous, more intelligent, good at sport etc.)
.....

if I had known ... I wish I had known ...

A Study this example situation:

Last month Gary was in hospital for a few days. Rachel didn't know this.
A few days ago they met by chance. Rachel said:

If I'd known you were in hospital, **I would have gone** to visit you.
(= I didn't know, so I didn't go to visit you)

If I'd known = If I **had** known. This tells us that she *didn't* know before.

We use **if + had ('d)** ... to talk about the past (**if I'd known / if you'd done** etc.):

- ☐ I didn't see you when you passed me in the street. **If I'd seen** you, I would have said hello.
- ☐ They didn't go out last night. They would have gone out **if they hadn't been** so tired. (but they were tired)
- ☐ **If you'd been looking** where you were going, you wouldn't have walked into the wall. (but you weren't looking)
- ☐ The view was wonderful. I would have taken some pictures **if I'd had** (= if I **had had**) a camera with me. (but I didn't have a camera)

Compare:

- ☐ I'm not hungry. **If I was** hungry, I would eat something. (*now*)
- ☐ I wasn't hungry. **If I had been** hungry, I would have eaten something. (*past*)

B We do *not* say 'if something would have happened'. We use **would** in the other part of the sentence:

- ☐ **If I had seen** you, **I would have said** hello. (*not* If I would have seen you)

The short form **'d** can be **would** or **had**:

- ☐ If **I'd seen** you, (I'd seen = I **had** seen)
I'd have said hello. (I'd have said = I **would** have said)

C We use **had done/known/been** etc. in the same way after **wish**.

I wish something **had happened** = I am sorry that it didn't happen

I wish something **hadn't happened** = I am sorry that it happened

- ☐ **I wish I'd known** that Gary was ill. I would have gone to see him. (but I didn't know)
- ☐ I feel sick. **I wish I hadn't eaten** so much. (I ate too much)
- ☐ Do you **wish you'd studied** science instead of languages? (you didn't study science)

Compare:

- ☐ **I'm glad I saw** him. (= I **saw** him)
- ☐ **I wish I'd seen** him. (= I **didn't see** him)

We do *not* say 'wish ... would have ...'.

- ☐ The weather was cold. I wish it **had been** warmer. (*not* I wish it would have been)

D Compare **would (do)** and **would have (done)**:

- ☐ If I'd gone to the party last night, **I would be** tired now. (I am not tired now – *present*)
- ☐ If I'd gone to the party last night, **I would have met** lots of people. (I didn't meet lots of people – *past*)

Compare **would have**, **could have** and **might have**:

- ☐ If the weather hadn't been so bad, { we **would have gone** out.
we **could have gone** out.
(= we would have been able to go out)
we **might have gone** out.
(= maybe we would have gone out)

Exercises

40.1 Put the verb into the correct form.

- I didn't see you. If I'd seen (I / see) you, I would have said (I / say) hello.
- Sarah got to the station just in time to catch her train to the airport. If (she / miss) the train, (she / miss) her flight too.
- Thanks for reminding me about Lisa's birthday. (I / forget) if (you / not / remind) me.
- I didn't have your email address, so I couldn't contact you. If (I / have) your email address, (I / send) you an email.
- Their trip was OK, but (they / enjoy) it more if the weather (be) better.
- Sorry we're late. Our taxi got stuck in the traffic. (it / be) quicker if (we / walk).
- Why didn't you tell me about your problem? If (you / tell) me, (I / try) to help you.
- I'm not tired. If (I / be) tired, I'd go home now.
- I wasn't tired last night. If (I / be) tired, I would have gone home earlier.

40.2 For each situation, write a sentence beginning with **If**.

- I wasn't hungry, so I didn't eat anything.
If I'd been hungry, I would have eaten something.
- The accident happened because the road was icy.
If the road
- I didn't know that you had to get up early, so I didn't wake you up.
If I
- Unfortunately I lost my phone, so I couldn't call you.
.....
- Karen wasn't injured in the crash, because fortunately she was wearing a seat belt.
.....
- You didn't have any breakfast – that's why you're hungry now.
.....
- I didn't get a taxi because I didn't have enough money.
.....
- Dan didn't do well at school, so he couldn't go to university.
.....

40.3 Imagine that you are in these situations. For each situation, write a sentence with **I wish**.

- You've eaten too much and now you feel sick.
You say: I wish I hadn't eaten so much.
- When you were younger, you never learned to play a musical instrument. Now you regret this.
You say:
- You've painted the gate red. Now you think it doesn't look good. Red was the wrong colour.
You say:
- You decided to travel by car, but the journey was long and tiring. Going by train would have been better.
You say: I wish we
- Last year you went to New York with a friend. You didn't have time to do all the things you wanted to do.
You say:
- You moved to a new flat a few months ago. Now you don't like your new flat. You think that moving was a bad idea.
You say:

A We say '**wish** somebody **luck** / **all the best** / **success**' etc. :

- ☐ I **wish you all the best** in the future.
- ☐ I saw Mark before the exam and **he wished me luck**.

We say '**wish** somebody *something*' (**luck**, **happiness** etc.), but we do not say 'I wish something *happens*'. We use **hope** in this situation:

- ☐ I'm sorry you're not well. I **hope** you **feel** better soon. (*not* I wish you feel)

Compare **I wish** and **I hope**:

- ☐ I **wish** you **a pleasant stay** at this hotel.
- ☐ I **hope** you **enjoy** your stay at this hotel. (*not* I wish you enjoy)

B We also use **wish** to say that we regret something, that something is not as we would like it.

When we use **wish** in this way, we use the *past* (**knew/lived** etc.), but the meaning is *present*:

- ☐ I **wish I knew** what to do about the problem. (but I don't know)
- ☐ I **wish you didn't** have to go so soon. (but you have to go)
- ☐ Do you **wish you lived** near the sea? (you don't live near the sea)
- ☐ Jack's going on a trip to Mexico soon. I **wish I was** going too. (but I'm not going)

To say that we regret something that happened before, we use **wish** + **had** known / **had** said etc. :

- ☐ I **wish I'd known** about the party. I'd have gone if I'd known. (but I didn't know)
- ☐ It was a stupid thing to say. I **wish I hadn't said** it. (but I said it)

See also Units 39 and 40.

C I **wish I could** (do something) = I regret that I cannot do it:

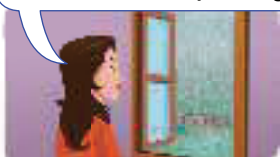
- ☐ I'm sorry you have to go. I **wish you could stay** longer. (but you can't)
- ☐ I've met that man before. I **wish I could remember** his name. (but I can't)

I **wish I could have** (done something) = I regret that I could not do it:

- ☐ I hear the party was great. I **wish I could have gone**. (but I couldn't go)

D You can say 'I **wish** something **would** happen'. For example:

I **wish it would stop** raining.



It's been raining all day. Tanya doesn't like it. She says:

I **wish it would stop** raining.

Tanya would like the rain to stop, but this will probably not happen.

We use **I wish ... would** when we would like something to happen or change.

We often use **I wish ... would** to complain about a situation:

- ☐ The phone has been ringing for five minutes. I **wish** somebody **would answer** it.
- ☐ I **wish you'd do** (= you **would** do) something instead of just sitting and doing nothing.

You can use **I wish ... wouldn't ...** to complain about things that people do repeatedly:

- ☐ I **wish you wouldn't keep** interrupting me. (= please stop interrupting me)

E We use **I wish ... would ...** to say that we want something *to happen*. We do not use **I wish ... would ...** to say how we would like things *to be*. Compare:

- ☐ I **wish** Sarah **would** come. (= I want her to come)
- but I **wish** Sarah **was** (or **were**) here now. (*not* I wish Sarah would be)
- ☐ I **wish** somebody **would buy** me a car.
- but I **wish** I **had** a car. (*not* I wish I would have)

Exercises

41.1 Put in **wish(ed)** or **hope(d)**.

- I wish you a pleasant stay at this hotel.
- Enjoy your holiday. I you have a great time.
- Goodbye. I you all the best for the future.
- We said goodbye to each other and each other luck.
- We're going to have a picnic tomorrow, so I the weather is nice.
- Congratulations on your new job. I you every success.
- Good luck in your new job. I it works out well for you.

41.2 Complete the sentences.

- Jack is going on a trip to Mexico soon. I wish I was going too.
- I'm very tired and I have so much to do. I wish I so tired.
- You didn't tell me you were ill. Why not? I wish you me.
- I don't have enough free time. I wish I more free time.
- I can't make up my mind what to do. I wish I decide.
- I bought these shoes, but now I don't like them. I wish I them.
- We have to go out now and I don't want to go. I wish we to go out now.
- Unfortunately I couldn't go to the wedding last month. I wish I could

41.3 What do you say in these situations? Write sentences with **I wish ... would ...**.

- It's raining. You want to go out, but not in the rain.
You say: I wish it would stop raining.
- You're waiting for Jane. She's late and you're getting impatient.
You say to yourself: I wish she
- You're looking for a job – so far without success. Nobody will give you a job.
You say: I wish somebody
- You can hear a dog barking. It's been barking a long time and you're trying to study.
You say:

For the following situations, write sentences with **I wish ... wouldn't ...**.

- Your friend is driving very fast. She always drives fast and you don't like this.
You say to her: I wish you
- Joe leaves the door open all the time. This annoys you.
You say to Joe:
- A lot of people drop litter in the street. You don't like this.
You say: I wish people

41.4 Put the verb into the correct form.

- It was a stupid thing to say. I wish I hadn't said it. (I / not / say)
- I'm fed up with this rain. I wish it would stop. (it / stop)
- It's a difficult question. I wish the answer. (I / know)
- I really didn't enjoy the party. I wish (we / not / go)
- I wish We've been waiting for 20 minutes. (the bus / come)
- You're lucky to be going away. I wish with you. (I / can / come)
- Our flat is rather small. I wish a bit bigger. (it / be)
- I should have listened to you. I wish your advice. (I / take)
- You keep interrupting me! I wish (you / listen)
- You're always complaining. I wish all the time. (you / not / complain)
- It's freezing today. I wish so cold. I hate cold weather. (it / not / be)
- I wish It's horrible! (the weather / change)
- I wish a piano. I'd love to have one. (I / have)
- When we were in London last year, we didn't have time to see all the things we wanted to see.
I wish there longer. (we / can / stay)